

The Skill System

This guide explains how Nerva OS actually does its job. Once you understand this, you'll get sharper results from every conversation.

What a Skill Is

A **skill** is one specialised AI worker your assistant can call on.

Think of your assistant as the head of a small agency. When you ask for something, the assistant figures out which specialist on the team is best for the job and hands it over.

You don't have a one-size-fits-all chatbot. You have 37 specialists. Each one knows a specific job inside out.

Examples of what a single skill knows:

- The copywriting skill knows the difference between a headline that sells and a headline that doesn't.
- The research skill knows how to find real data instead of making things up.
- The ad-creative skill knows how to write twenty Facebook ad variations without repeating itself.

That depth is the whole point. Specialists beat generalists.

How Your Assistant Picks One

You don't need to memorise the skills. You just describe what you want in plain English.

You say: "Write me a sales email for my new product."

Your assistant thinks: That sounds like the **email-composer** skill. Let me use that.

You say: "What are my competitors charging?"

Your assistant thinks: That sounds like the **competitive-cartographer** skill. Let me use that.

The matching happens silently. You never see it unless you ask.

How to Call One Directly

Sometimes you know exactly which specialist you want. In that case, just name it.

You say: "Use the **brainstorming** skill to help me think about this."

You say: "Use the **deep-research** skill to dig into this topic."

You say: "Use the **retro** skill to review what happened last quarter."

Calling a skill by name forces the assistant to use that specialist. Handy when you've found one you trust.

The 37 Skills, by Category

Here is everything in the box. Each category includes one prompt you can try right now.

Foundation (5 skills)

The skills that make the whole system work.

Skill	What it does
first-run-setup	Walks you through onboarding the first time you launch
skill-creator	Helps you build your own custom skill
writing-plans	Turns a fuzzy idea into a structured plan
brainstorming	Stress-tests an idea before you build it
orchestrator	Coordinates multiple skills for a single big request

Try this: "Use the **writing-plans** skill to plan my product launch."

Marketing & Content (10 skills)

Anything that involves writing words to sell something.

Skill	What it does
copywriting	Writes landing pages, websites, taglines, value props
humanizer	Rewrites AI-sounding text to sound human
avoid-ai-writing	Audits and removes 21 common AI writing patterns
content-creator	SEO-friendly blog posts and articles
social-content	Posts for Instagram, LinkedIn, Twitter, TikTok

Skill	What it does
social-orchestrator	Plans a full week of social posts at once
ad-creative	Bulk ad headlines, descriptions, body text
email-sequence	Multi-step drip campaigns and welcome series
email-composer	One-off emails for sales, customers, partners
direct-response-copy	Long-form sales letters and VSL scripts

Try this: "Use the **copywriting** skill to rewrite my homepage headline."

Research (6 skills)

Skills that find real information instead of guessing.

Skill	What it does
deep-research	Multi-step research with full source citations
research-analyst	Market research and trend analysis
reddit-insights	Finds what real people are saying on Reddit
last30days	Reddit, X, and web from the last 30 days only
competitive-cartographer	Maps your competitive landscape
competitor-alternatives	Builds "X vs Y" pages for SEO and sales

Try this: "Use the **competitive-cartographer** skill to map my top three competitors."

Sales & Strategy (5 skills)

Skills for thinking about how the business actually makes money.

Skill	What it does
sales-automator	Sales sequences, cold outreach, follow-ups
paid-ads	Strategy for Google, Meta, LinkedIn ads
indie-monetization-strategist	Pricing and revenue ideas for small operators

Skill	What it does
product-appeal-analyzer	Tests whether people actually want what you're selling
tech-entrepreneur-coach-adhd	A coach for distractible founders

Try this: "Use the **indie-monetization-strategist** skill to suggest three ways I could earn from my email list."

Automation & Operations (5 skills)

Skills that do real things in real tools.

Skill	What it does
playwright-skill	Drives your browser to do tasks for you
webapp-testing	Tests websites and finds bugs
qa	Reviews your site or app and reports problems
prompt-engineer	Improves prompts so you get sharper results
agent-creator	Builds custom AI assistants for repeating jobs

Try this: "Use the **qa** skill to review my website and find anything broken."

Productivity & Quality (4 skills)

Skills that make your other work sharper.

Skill	What it does
verification-before-completion	Double-checks work before saying it's done
diagramming-expert	Builds clear diagrams from messy ideas
technical-writer	Writes documentation people actually read
youtube-summarizer	Summarises long videos into key takeaways

Try this: "Use the **youtube-summarizer** skill on this video link."

Personal (2 skills)

For your own life, not just the business.

Skill	What it does
personal-finance-coach	Plans, investing, tax, retirement
retro	Reviews what went well and what didn't

Try this: "Use the **retro** skill to review my last three months."

How to Add Your Own

You can build your own skill in about ten minutes.

1. Say to your assistant: "Use the **skill-creator** skill to help me build a new one."
2. It will ask what the skill should do.
3. Describe the job. Be specific.
4. It will write the skill file and save it for you.

Your custom skills sit alongside the 37 we ship with. They work the same way.

Want more, ready-made? We sell an **Engineering Pack** with 56 extra specialist skills for developers, technical founders, and anyone running software. Ask your assistant about it when you're ready, or email support@nerva-os.com.

What's NOT a Skill

Most of what you ask your assistant is just a normal conversation. Skills are for specialist jobs.

These are NOT skill jobs:

- "What time is it in London?"
- "Explain this concept to me."
- "Help me think through this email I got."
- "What do you think of this idea?"
- "Summarise our last conversation."

For these, the assistant just answers directly. No specialist needed.

A good rule: if it would take a human specialist more than ten minutes, it's probably a skill job.

Next: If something breaks during all of this, open [09 — Troubleshooting](#). Most issues have a two-minute fix.